



Saturday, the 20th of April 2024



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Day one promised a multitude of fiery debates in the committees. Here's a recap of the intense discussions:

Counter Terrorism Committee Confronts Global Radicalization Challenges

This year's Counter Terrorism Committee began with the delegates of the 18 countries presenting their opening remarks on the crises arising because of terrorist groups affecting society. Numerous delegates stated their concerns regarding the safety of youth, education, and national security, as these are highly affected by the rising radical ideologies around the world. Such political disputes were highly debated in the follow-up discussions after the DPRK's remarks. Thus, many questions arose about the country's education system, the risks regarding poverty among the youth, alongside the possible correlations between this phenomenon and the emergence of radical groupings among the younger demographic.

The French delegate responded to numerous questions about the links between immigration and the recurring terrorist attacks. Therefore, the discussions gravitated around the pillars of the UN strategies for combating terrorism, alongside the policies implemented by France to penalise all kinds of radical groupings that may create disputes in society. The delegates for Turkiye and Laos informed the delegate of France about the possible implications of the Israel-Hamas conflicts, and the Boko Haram crises in Nigeria in the radicalization of ideologies around the world.

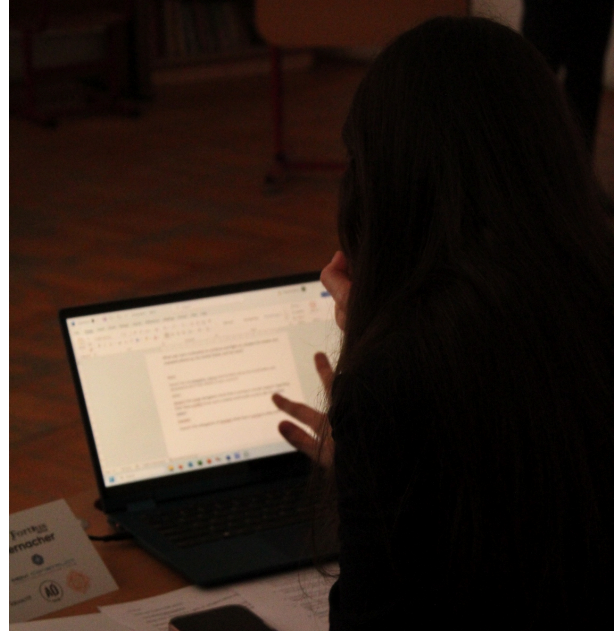


Controversies after India's Speech in the Human Rights Council

On Saturday, the HRC discussed the links between radical terrorist groups and the challenges in protecting human rights. The delegate for India stated the implications of the actions of the Nigerian Boko Haram for the safety of society. However, numerous delegates stated their remarks on the anti-muslim uprisings in the Asian republic, alongside problems regarding the rights of women, as these issues inform the situation presented by the Indian representative.

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Thus, the delegate assured the council that India is working on addressing these concerns, and that the Republic is strictly against any form of terrorism. Such topics were strongly debated in the follow-up questions with the delegates of the Middle Eastern countries, alongside the tense relations with the United States, keeping in mind the fact that through such partnerships, the Middle Eastern states can be supported in the present conflicts regarding security and in the implementation of human rights. The committee's main goal was to combat the risks posed by Boko Haram and ISIS.



Delegates Unite on Key Agreements in the Commission on the Status of Women



The Commission on the Status of Women took up for discussion numerous subjects regarding the rights and safety of women. Delegates discussed the links between economic status and current issues arising in the sex industry, such as the level of education that young girls and women can benefit from.

The speeches commented on the dangers of STDs on the health of sex workers, alongside the psychological and ethical implications of prostitution. The delegate for France recommended international collaboration in resolving such issues, mostly focusing on circulating information in the media. As for the medical matters, France managed to create therapy programs for sex workers.

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The delegations spoke about the increasing violence against women, both of physical and of sexual nature. The German delegate stressed that in their country's case, prostitutes are always protected by the law, and so is any other woman, no matter their background. This protection has seen a positive development since the 2002 German legalisation of prostitution, due to the fact that these women need to register as workers in this field. In light of this subject, it was strongly stated that law enforcement is working on reducing person trafficking, abuse, and, sadly, the numerous cases of murder linked with the legalisation and surfacing of the sex industry in some countries. Mandatory police control of brothels has been implemented, as most of the establishments are managed by illegal organisations and criminal gangs.

Collaborative Solutions in the United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime

This year's UNODC discussed the risks of drug trafficking and the usage of narcotics. Many delegates stated their government's positions in reducing the illegal circulation of substances, and the implications of border security in further handling these problems, mostly by strengthening law enforcement and border control systems. The governments' representatives commented on the impacts of the economic status of some of the countries on the usage of drugs.

A significant number of representatives noted that their countries are seeking to collaborate more thoroughly with each other in order to combat the risks posed by crime and drugs. Out of the member states, Iran was the most open to further strengthen such relations, both in the Middle Eastern space and around the world. These collaborations, as noted from the speeches, will play an important role from a diplomatic standpoint.



During the presentations, the South African delegate to the UNODC received many questions regarding the production and export of illegal substances in and from the country. The representative thus assured the participants that South Africa is looking to further combat such problems, and that it seeks the help and support of member states. Most of the speeches gravitated around finding solutions and explanations for all illegal activities of this kind.

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Following these topics, the delegate for the United States openly informed the council that the production of drugs in America is lower compared to the import from other countries. Therefore, the US did not take full responsibility for the substance crisis it is facing, but it showed that numerous other countries have strong involvement in the matter.

Tensions Escalate as the Crisis Council Wrestles with Diplomatic Strain

The Crisis Council focused its discussions around the issue of fog in Siberia due to smoke caused by wildfires. Due to the aerosolized smoke particles affecting the health and safety of the Russian citizens, many refugees have been seen evacuating the region.

Thus, the Russian Federation looked for support from fellow UN member states. Japan stated that it is seeking to strengthen relations with Russia regarding this matter.



Another issue discussed was the tension between Japan and North Korea, following the death of a Japanese ambassador. The DPRK issued the possibility of starvation as the cause of death, however the Japanese delegate assured the council that an autopsy has been performed following the passing of the official. During the debates, inquiries arose about the country in question respecting diplomatic immunity and the right to life, which has created some dispute in the committee.

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SNEAK PEEK

With one of the chairs of DISEC:

How is the work in your committee going?

It's going really well, we're now sending the working papers to the approval panel.

Do you already have a nominee for the titles?

Yes, right from the beginning we spotted some delegates that had really good POIs and follow-ups.

What would you choose? 100 ducks or 1 pig?

I will choose 100 ducks because they are fluffier.

With one of the chairs of SPECPOL:

How is your committee going?

We are having lobbying time right now so I think it's going really well.

What do you think came first? The chicken or the egg?

I used to be asked this question a lot when I was in kindergarten (when I thought I was smarter than everyone!) and my answer was always that 'first there were two atoms, which became four, which became... atoms!, and then something became... but I never specified *what.*'

Do you have someone in mind for the title of best delegate?

We have a lot of talented people so not yet.

#THE REAL MUNOB



Send us your own funny moments at @spotted_munob !!!